

KF Reading Guide

Chapter 2: *Neurotic Claims*¹

1. In what two worlds do neurotics live? (40.1)
 - A.
 - B.
2. Is the neurotic consciously aware of living in two worlds? (40.1)
3. What do neurotics conclude about the world? (41.1)
4. To what kinds of things do neurotics feel entitled? (41.2)
5. Neurotics will not do something about their problems but expect others to do what? (41.2)
6. When does a wish turn into a claim? (42.2)
7. As neurotics, what do we feel when claims are not fulfilled? (42.2)
8. Are neurotics willing to see the difference between a need and a claim? (42.3)
9. In general, to what do neurotics feel entitled? (42.4)
10. Toward what are neurotic claims directed? (43.1)

11. In what situations have you experienced the claims mentioned in the book or any other claims? (43.4–44.1)
12. What two claims did the author recognize when she was put off her flight? (44.4)
 - A.
 - B.
13. When neurotics claim to be an exception, they want to be exempt from what? (44.5–45.2)
14. Neurotics have an intense, unconscious aversion to what? (45.3)
15. Why are neurotics averse to the recognition of any necessities applying to themselves? (45.3)
16. Give one or more examples from your own life of a claim toward life in general. (46.1-3)
17. What appears as resentful envy toward others? (47.1)
18. Neurotics want to be relieved of their difficulties without having to do what? (47.2)
19. In what two regards are claims unrealistic? (47.4–48.2)
 - A.
 - B.
20. What is a third characteristic of a claim? (49.2)

21. Which of the claims described do you recognize in yourself or others? What other claims might be active in your life? (48.2–51.1)
22. What is the fourth characteristic of claims? (51.2)
23. Are neurotics conscious of their claims? (51.3)
24. What enables neurotics to see their lives in general as they need to see them? (51.4)
25. Why do neurotics exaggerate their merits? (53.1)
26. How do people use culture to support claims? (53.2)
27. What is the always present base of claims? (53.3)
28. Does it help neurotics if we refuse to accede to their claims? (54.1)
29. Which of these or any other grounds for claims resonate with you? (53–55)

30. Why is it important for neurotics to assert claims? (55.3)
31. What can we expect if claims are frustrated? (55.4–56.1)
32. Hostility arises only if a frustration is, or is felt to be, what? (56.2)
33. What results from this indignation that so drastically influences our judgment of others? (56.2)
34. What are the three courses neurotic anger takes? (56.3–57.1)
- A.
 - B.
 - C.
35. It is easy to observe neurotic reactions in others, but what is in our real interest? (57.2)
36. What is not too difficult to recognize and discover? (57.2)
37. What are neurotics entirely incapable of tolerating? (58.1)
38. What judgment makes adversity ten times harder? (58.2)
39. What prevents neurotics from following valid advice? (59.1)
40. What are the consequences of emotional blindness? (59.2)
41. What is another consequence of living by claims? (59.3)
42. What is perhaps the most frequent neurotic disturbance? (60.1)

43. For what are claims a substitute? (60.1)
44. For neurotics, what should be enough to bring about any desired achievement? (60.1)
45. What unconscious belief do neurotics hold? (61.2)
46. What are all claims pervaded by? (62.1)
47. Claims are an indispensable means of what? (62.1)
48. For what are the claims a guaranty? (62.1)
49. As the neurotic loses interest in his actual life, what happens? (62.2)
50. What do neurotics feel they would lose if they became interested in themselves and their growth?
(62.3)
51. To what extent are neurotics capable of considering the way to health? (63.1)
52. What is the overall function of claims? (63.2)
53. When we raise our “needs” to the dignity of claims, what are we doing? (63.2)

¹ This reading guide refers to the 1991 edition of *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle Toward Self-Realization* by Karen Horney, published by W.W. Norton and Company Inc. New York.